Let It Bleed

or

You Can’t Always Get What You Want

(But if you try sometimes, well, you might find

You get what you need)

(7 October 2026)

(Français)

An open letter to my son Arthur [1]

On September 28, 2026, a dear friend of fifty years, who lives more than one thousand kilometers away and whom I haven't seen in nearly a decade, acted graciously as a remote messenger and sent you and Jacqueline, your mother, a link to my main GitHub file repository.

Five days later, after nearly seven years of unbroken silence, you apparently deleted all our past WhatsApp correspondence and replaced it with one single link:



[1] Born 1986.

Since you supplied no words of explanation, I cannot know for sure what meaning you intended me to take from the song. However, I attempted to find a logical equivalent to the verses, and I propose:

Some of what you want you can never get, while
Trying is not enough to get even what is just needed,
With the consequence that
How do you get what you need just to survive?

The messenger has observed to me, however, that it is the fate of most, if not of **all**, to **never** obtain anything of what one wants, a position which plain experience seems to contradict.

To test the logic of this view against the physical reality of life, please find hereafter a limited list of things I would want, let alone would need, accompanied by some remarks.

As a preamble, please recall that I have lived in total seclusion and isolation throughout the period since you stopped visiting and calling, far from the closest neighbor, my only company being animal life, in particular seven (or eight, depending on the day) half-feral dogs, who do provide however not only good and faithful company, but also the only security there is in these remote parts.

Because denial is a common psychological defense against deeply unpleasant realities, I ask anyone reading this paper to make his or her own assessment, by indicating in the two columns to the right of the table below whether my circumstances are, in fact, absolutely common (Column C) or, on the contrary, perhaps somewhat uncommon (Column U).

It seems unlikely that **nobody** would ever have **any** of the following needs or wishes satisfied:

		C	U
1.	A series of visits to the dentist to repair six painful broken molars, the last visit dating back 26 years ago;		
2.	A series of at least five visits to the clinic in order to operate the two massive painful [2] inguinal hernias that occurred nine years ago as a consequence of hard work discharged without any help;		
3.	The necessarily assisted weeks-long convalescence at home after each operation;		
4.	Some other miscellaneous medical attention, at the age of 72, noting that my last visit to a physician's office or medical facility dates back nearly 16 years ago;		
5.	Some treatment for the four syncopes with short cardiac arrests I experienced in total isolation on September 6, 2026, between the hours of 11 AM and 2 PM;		
6.	Some consideration for three shorter losses of consciousness I experienced on the afternoon of September 28;		
7.	The ability to obtain basic prescription reading glasses;		
8.	The ability to obtain an operation on my left eye for what seems to be cataract;		
9.	The reestablishment of mail delivery to my isolated		

[2] and at times incapacitating.

location, which was interrupted four months ago and precludes timely mail and package delivery, including registered [3];

10. Access to transportation, the lack of which has barred me from ever leaving my property in the past seven years, even for a minute;

11. An end to the full seizure of my bank accounts, including of the legally unseizable minimum bank balance of 650 euros;

12. The restoration of basic medical and home insurance coverage, following the systematic rejection of my monthly premium payments as a consequence of the seizure of my bank accounts;

13. An end to the full seizure of my house and property;

14. The return of nearly two million dollars owed to me;

15. The resolution of the daily nightmare of nearly ten years of intense litigation across two countries and ten separate courts of law;

16. Reparation and compensation for the nearly consummated illegal desecration, transfer of all of its content to some common grave, and sale to others of our family vault at the hands of the local government;

17. Reparation and compensation for the environmental destruction of large tracts of my property by governmental

[3] On the bright side, the grocery store located 32 kilometers away continues its monthly deliveries.

action;

18. Reparation and compensation for the illegal diversion of the water table, river, and springs at the hands of the local government, with the resulting total dry-up of water resources eight months out of the year and the corresponding steep loss of property value;

19. Reassessment of the fraudulent assessment of my property for tax purposes;

20. Consideration of my very limited income of 800 euros per month;

21. Consideration of the incidental fact that I never had red meat, or a dish of fish [4], in more than seven years ;

22. After nearly seven years of silence, an explanation of my son's refusal to state openly the general reasons for severing all communication with me;

23. In particular, an explanation of what could be so unpleasant that he remains unwilling to disclose it;

24. An explanation as to the rationale behind my consistently imploring our common friends to beg him to disclose those reasons, if the reasons for my son's refusal were indeed so unpleasant;

25. The reestablishment of access to basic indoor sanitation;

26. Access to garbage disposal, which I haven't had for nine years, despite being charged 7,700 euros for it.

[4] Or coffee for some time.

among numerous other things I indeed would want, let alone would need.

If it is truly the basic fate of **nobody** on Earth to ever get what is wanted or just needed for survival, then these lines above should reveal that my daily existence is completely ordinary.

However, if the lines reveal a substantial departure from the ordinary, then the proposition that nobody ever gets what is wanted cannot, by itself, explain the circumstances described above.

I have consistently asked our common friends whether you might be willing to explain the reasons for your decision to cease communicating with me, not in order to assign blame to my only son, who is to me irreplaceable, but because I would rather know an unpleasant truth, about which I could act, than allow silence, supposition, or misunderstanding to become the permanent record between us.

If there is something I have done, or something you believe I have done, that led to nearly seven years of unexplained silence, I remain willing to hear it, however unpleasant it may be, and to respond to it as accurately and openly as I can.

Nothing in this letter is intended to require a response from you nor to prescribe what that response should be, but it is my belief and experience that whenever truth is genuinely sought, things are better said than occultated or inferred.

https://marc-moszkowski.github.io/